

Manuel Jesús Brenes Flores

Doctoral Researcher in Private International Law

Ph.D. expected: March 2026

Academic affiliation: Universidad Pablo de Olavide, Seville (Spain)

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ACADEMIC PROFILE

Researcher and University Lecturer in Private International Law, specialising in European Union law and comparative succession systems. My work focuses on doctrinal and practical approaches to legislative and case-law developments across Spain, Italy, Germany, France, and the United Kingdom.

My current research explores the circulation of succession mechanisms in cross-border contexts within the European Union, with particular attention to conflict-of-laws issues and Regulation (EU) No 650/2012, with a view to proposing a refined model for European succession law.

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Private International Law

Universidad Pablo de Olavide, Seville (Spain)

*** Thesis to be submitted by 2026**

Doctoral research focused on the legal framework and comparative analysis of succession agreements in Europe, with special attention to Spain, Italy, Germany, France, and the United Kingdom. Currently in the final stage of writing.

Supervisors: Dr. Andrés Rodríguez Benot and Dr. Juan Pablo Pérez Velázquez.

LL.M. in European Union Law

UNED - Universidad Nacional de Educación a Distancia (Spain) - 2024

Specialisation in the EU legal order, judicial cooperation, and the role of European institutions in private international law.

LL.M. in International Family Law and Succession

UNIR - Universidad Internacional de La Rioja (Spain) - 2023

Focused on personal and patrimonial aspects of family relationships in Spanish and comparative law.

LL.M. in Legal Practice (Bar Admission)

UNIR - Universidad Internacional de La Rioja (Spain) - (2021)

Preparation for the Spanish bar exam and training in litigation and procedural practice.

LL.B. in Law

Universidad de Sevilla (Spain) - (2020)

Completed additional specialisation in Civil Law and Family Law.

Diploma in Family and Succession Law

Universidad Pablo de Olavide, Seville (Spain)

Focus on marital property regimes and succession systems.

Executive Diploma in Cybersecurity

Universidad Pontificia de Salamanca (Spain) - (2022)

Training in digital risk, cybersecurity and AI-based legal issues.

University Expert in Trial Litigation Techniques

Universidad Internacional de La Rioja (Spain) - (2019)

Practical oral advocacy and procedural training. Taught by Óscar Fernández León.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

University Lecturer in Private International Law

Pablo de Olavide University, Seville (Spain) — 2026 Jan – Present

Undergraduate teaching in Private International Law within the Bachelor's Degree in Law and Double Degree in Law and Politic Sciences. Topics include jurisdiction, applicable law, recognition and enforcement of foreign decisions, and EU instruments in civil and commercial matters.

ACADEMIC AND RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Directed Studies in Private International Law

The Hague Academy of International Law, The Hague (Netherlands) - 2026 Jul - Aug 2026

Summer Course and Directed Studies took from Prof. Dário MOURA VICENTE, Prof. María ALBORNOZ, Prof. Stavros BREKOULAKIS, Prof. Richard OPPONG, Prof. Paul ARRIGHI, Prof. Laurence USUNIER, Prof. Laura CARBALLO PIÑEIRO and Prof. Giesela RÜHL.

*** Funded by Law Faculty's Universidad Pablo de Olavide Fellowship**

Doctoral Researcher in Private International Law

Universidad Pablo de Olavide, Seville (Spain) - 2021 - Present

Doctoral thesis on the comparative analysis of succession agreements in Spain, Italy, Germany, France, and the United Kingdom.

Doctoral Visiting Researcher

Università di Foggia (Italy) - 2025 Sept - Feb 2026

Research stay focused on Italian materials in the field of succession law and private international law (*patti successori*) and comparative European approaches.

*** Funded by Erasmus+ Mobility Programme (EU).**

Supervisor: Dr. Carlos Vidal Prado, Dr. Annichino Pasquale and Dr. Valentina Cuocci.

Doctoral Visiting Researcher

Swiss Institute of Comparative Law, Lausanne (Switzerland) - 2025 Jun - Sept 2025

Research stay focused on comparative aspects of succession law under European private international law frameworks.

Supervisor: Dr. Ilaria Pretelli.

Research Collaborator

Universidad Pablo de Olavide, Seville (Spain) - 2023 - 2024

Academic support and collaboration in postgraduate programs. Participation in internal research seminars and doctoral activities.

*** Funded by Doctoral School Programme of Universidad Pablo de Olavide, Seville.**

PUBLICATIONS (AND PREPRINTS)

- “*The Historical Path of Succession Agreements in Europe: From Roman Law to Modern Private International Law*” (in preparation). Historical and comparative reconstruction of succession agreements from Roman law to contemporary European private international law. Target journal: *Revista de Humanidades*.
- “*Succession Agreements in Europe: Towards a Common Framework under Regulation (EU) 650/2012*” (2026). Critical and prospective analysis of succession agreements in European private international law. [Published in](#) *Cuadernos de Derecho Transnacional*, Vol. 18 No. 1 (2026).
- “*The Evolution of Regulation (EU) 650/2012 in Its Decennial Review: A Reflection from Notarial Practice and Comparative Experience*” (forthcoming 2026). Revised and extended version of a paper presented at the IV International Conference of Young Researchers INNOVA-Salamanca. Selected for publication by Ediciones Universidad de Salamanca.
- “*Enhanced Professio Iuris in the Revision of Regulation (EU) 650/2012: An Equitable Method of Succession Freedom in Europe*” (forthcoming 2026). Chapter selected for publication following the I International Conference on the Revision of Regulation (EU) 650/2012: Ten Years of Application (Barcelona). Expected publication before Summer 2026.

– “*Isolation, Integration, Fragmentation: Private International Law as Economic Governance in Europe*” (invited contribution, under preparation). Article accepted for publication in the *European Yearbook of International Economic Law (EYIEL)* 2026, Focus Section. Submission in April 2026.

Full list and supporting documentation available upon request.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

– “Digitalisation of Succession Law in the EU: Towards Digital Succession Agreements and Their Impact on the European Legal Framework”

Paper presented at the **10th International Congress on the European Union**, Brussels (Belgium), 18-20 November 2024.

– “The evolution of Regulation (EU) 650/2012 in its ten-yr review: a reflection from notarial practice and experience compared”

Paper presented at the **IV Jornadas Internacionales de Jóvenes Investigadores INNOVA 2025**, Salamanca (Spain), 25-26 September 2025.

– “Twenty years of equal marriage in Spain: A model for Europe? Challenges and contrasts”

Paper presented at the **11th International Congress on the European Union**, Brussels (Belgium), 17-19 November 2025.

– “*Enhanced Professio Iuris in the Revision of Regulation (EU) 650/2012: An Equitable Method of Succession Freedom in Europe*”

Paper presented at the **I International Conference on the Revision of Regulation (EU) 650/2012: Ten Years of Application**, Barcelona (Spain), 2025.

– “*Twenty Years of Equal Marriage in Spain: Legal, Social and Demographic Impact of a Historical Transformation*”

Poster presentation at the **VI National Conference Conference of Early-Career Researchers (JIFFI8): Fostering Interdisciplinarity**, Granada (Spain), 4–6 February 2026.

– “International transfer of minors without prior placement. Practical gaps in Regulation (EU) 2019/1111 regarding the best interests of the child”

Paper presented at the **6th Congress of the International Doctoral School**, Universidad Rey Juan Carlos, Madrid (Spain), 13 May 2026.

– “Who holds authority in cross-border successions in Europe? Professional transformations in the era of artificial intelligence”

Paper presented at the **International Congress “100 Years of Social Studies in Spain”**, Faculty of Labour Sciences, Universidad de Huelva, Huelva (Spain), 7 May 2026.

– “International transfer of minors without prior placement. Practical gaps in Regulation (EU) 2019/1111 regarding the best interests of the child”

Paper presented at the **XIII International Competition on Private International Law Millennium DIPr.**, Universidad de Zaragoza, Zaragoza (Spain), 8 May 2026.

AWARDS, SCHOLARSHIPS AND RECOGNITIONS

Academic Excellence Scholarship — Universidad Internacional de La Rioja – *Full scholarship awarded for outstanding academic performance during the Master’s Degree in Family and Succession Law.*

Honours Distinction — Universidad de Sevilla – *Awarded highest grade (9.1/10) in Social Security Law during graduate studies.*

Erasmus+ Mobility Grant — European Union – *Funding for a short-term research stay at the University of Foggia (Italy), 2025 Sept - Dec 2026.*

Legal Clinic Participant — Universidad Internacional de La Rioja – *Completed the Legal Clinic in Labour and Social Security Law with top marks (10/10 in Microconsultations module).*

Finalist — Legal Entrepreneurship Lab, Mutualidad de la Abogacía (2021-2022) – *Recognised for legal project development and innovative practice design.*

Ambassador in Chile and Argentina — Fundación Atarazanas (2013) – *Selected to represent Spain in international cultural and academic exchange.*

LANGUAGES

- **Spanish:** Native
- **English:** Cambridge CAE 2018: C1 (194/210); Legal English Certificate
- **French:** A2 (Research skills)
- **Catalan / German:** Basic (A1-A2) (non-certified)

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Legal, academic and production software: Zotero, Mendeley, LaTeX, MS Word/Excel, Canva, Westlaw, EUR-Lex, REDI

ACADEMIC AND PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

Member, **AEAFA** – Spanish Association of Family Lawyers

REFERENCES

- Prof. Dr. Elena Isabel Cara Fuentes - Universidad de Almería (Spain) - elena7@ual.es
 - Prof. Dr. Andrés Rodríguez Benot - Universidad Pablo de Olavide (Spain) - arodbent@upo.es
- Additional references available upon request.